Weather risk facts and planning cards

Tuesday 16 March 2027 | P2 | 40 minutes | Year A

Humanities | LAUNCH | Spring 2 Week 4 | HUM-LAUNCH-S2-W04

White paper version. Read quietly, point, write, type, speak privately or direct a scribe who reads your words back. You may pass. No public answer or reading aloud is required.

Original learning summaries based on checked facts. No source extract, map or picture is reproduced. C codes identify the cards. G codes link to research titles and records in SOURCE_MANIFEST.json.

C1 Extreme weather and risk factors

Heavy rain, strong wind and extreme heat can cause impacts. Flooding can follow heavy or prolonged rain. Surface water flooding occurs when rain overwhelms drainage or cannot soak into the ground; it can happen away from a river. River flooding can follow heavy rain in a catchment. Hazard names the process that can cause harm. Exposure names who or what is in the affected area. Vulnerability is a condition that increases harm. Capacity is a strength or resource that helps. Research basis: G1–G6.

C2 Invented offline area records

All records below are invented for planning practice. Shared assumption: heavy rain lasts several hours. Likelihood and potential severity are given categories, not a real forecast, observation, warning or exact calculation. The map is invented and not to scale. B is planned water-storage land; its upper path is assumed to remain available. No pupil needs a live site.

Area	Exposure	Conditions and capacity	Flood likelihood	Potential severity
A	30 homes and 1 water pump	Older drains have limited capacity; pump equipment is low.	High	Major
B	0 homes and 1 footpath	Planned water-storage space and an upper path are available.	High	Minor
C	6 homes and the only access bridge	The area relies on one access route; approaches could flood.	Medium	Major

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C3 Read likelihood and severity together

Likelihood asks how likely flooding is. In this invented guide, low means possible but not expected, medium means possible, and high means likely, not certain. Severity asks how serious impacts could be if flooding occurs. Minor means short disruption with few important assets affected. Moderate means some buildings or routes affected with alternatives available. Major means homes, important services or the only access could be disrupted. A and B share high likelihood but have different severity. C has medium likelihood and major severity. The guide gives no exact risk score. Research basis for the two-factor idea: G2; the classroom categories are newly constructed.

C4 Planning choices have limits

Improving and maintaining drains can reduce some surface water flooding, but their capacity can be exceeded and they cannot stop every river flood. Raising or protecting pump equipment can reduce service vulnerability while homes remain exposed. An additional planned access route can reduce dependence on one bridge, but needs land, funding and maintenance. A measure may change likelihood, severity or the ability to cope. No measure removes all risk. These are planning options, not instructions to enter a flooded place. Research basis: G3, G7; option examples are teacher-written.

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C5 Explain without blame or certainty

Vulnerability can arise from infrastructure, housing, environment and access to resources. These conditions are often outside an individual’s control. People and communities also have knowledge and strengths. Explain the condition and what support could change it. A risk judgement is about possible harm, not proof that harm will happen. Before a real decision, planners need updated evidence, local knowledge and professional judgement. This exercise supplies only invented assumptions. Research basis: G4–G7.

Original planning prompts

Compare A and B: same likelihood, different potential severity. Use exposure, vulnerability and capacity to explain why. Compare A and C: both have major potential severity, but their chance categories differ. What extra evidence would improve a choice? Choose one measure, explain a benefit and a limit, and keep the invented label visible.

D1 The parts of risk

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D1 Risk has more than one part

Hazard

Heavy rain and the flooding it can cause.

Exposure

People, homes, routes and services in the affected area.

Vulnerability

Conditions that increase harm, such as low equipment or weak drains.

Capacity

Strengths and resources that help, such as robust services and plans.

Risk asks what harm could occur, how likely it is and how serious it could be.

Look at these factors together. Vulnerability is not a personal fault.

Use A to give an example of hazard, exposure and vulnerability. Use B to name one capacity.

Original concept guide. The factors are considered together; they are not a chain in which one automatically causes the next.

D2 Invented planning map

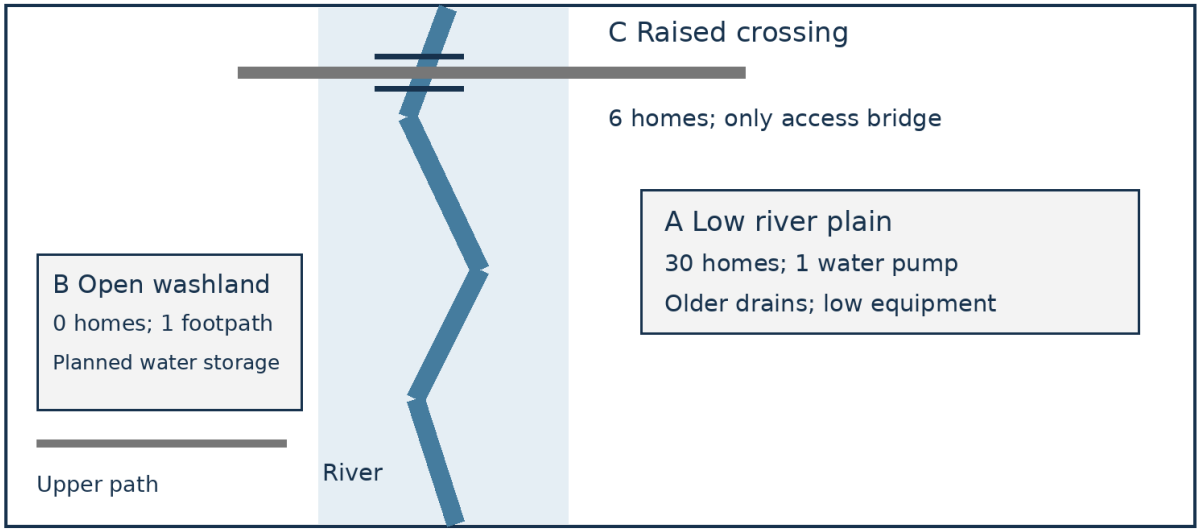
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D2 Invented catchment planning map

No real location or forecast. Not to scale. Areas and features are invented.



Key: blue line = river; pale band = river corridor; grey line = access route.

The map shows exposure and context. It does not predict where water will go.

Locate the homes, pump, storage land and single bridge. Which features affect exposure or the ability to cope?

Invented map, no real place and not to scale. It shows context for the planning cards, not flood extent, a forecast or an official warning.

D3 Chance and possible harm

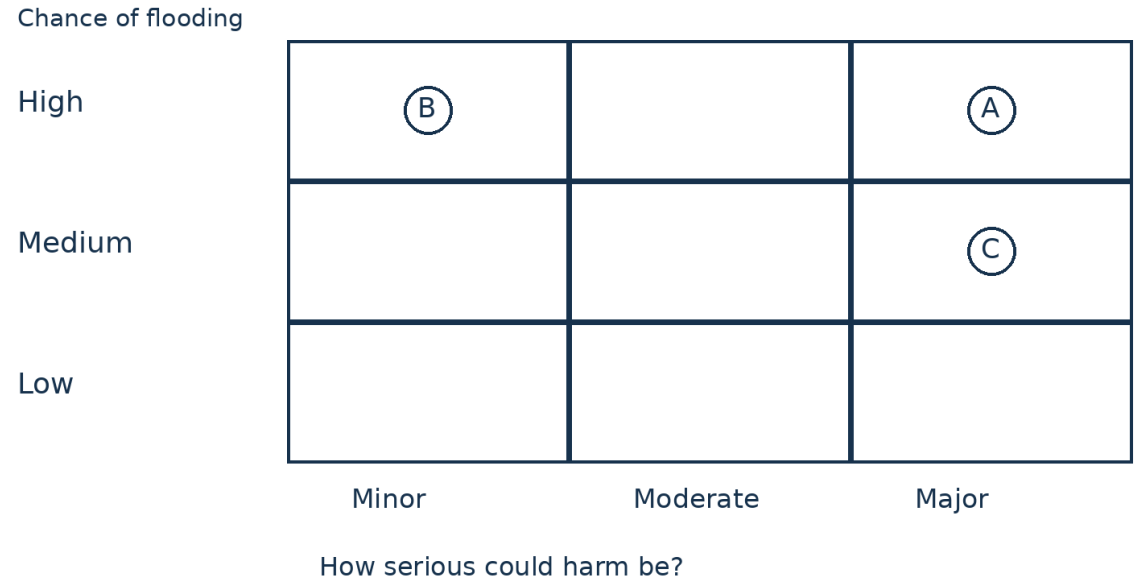
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D3 Chance and possible harm

This is a class task, not a real forecast. Use the given chance and harm groups.



A and B share the same chance. Harm could be greater in A. It may not happen.

Read A and B across both axes. Why do their potential impacts differ although the likelihood category is the same?

Invented qualitative classroom guide. No overall score or official warning colour is assigned. Given categories are assumptions, not exact probabilities.